KOMPAN®



PLAY FOR ALL

THE INCLUSIVE PLAYGROUND CHECKLIST

The main success factor for inclusive playgrounds is user satisfaction. You have probably witnessed the complexity in balancing interests when planning inclusive playgrounds: location analysis, ground preparation, equipment functionality, budget implications and, not least, user expectations need to be considered and acted upon. On top of that, the aesthetics and feel of the playground play a major role for civic pride and ownership.

This checklist presents the points to consider when designing successful, inclusive and universal playgrounds to make them attractive, fun and meaningful for all. Enjoy!

Let's play

THE UNIVERSAL PLAYGROUND DESIGN



STAYING:

- Accessible seating and table options
- Solitary play areas, e.g. panels or individual rotation pieces
- Colour contrasts on surfaces around moving play equipment, to assist guidance



PLAYING:

- Thrilling play functions, e.g. speed, height
- Spaciousness to support diverse body sizes, abilities and positions
- Play from all sides
- Ground-level accessibility and usability
- Sensory play variation: tactile, visual, auditive

GETTING AROUND:

- Transparency in design, for orientation
- Maps for orientation
- Easy access to and around all play equipment

CAN USERS GET AROUND IN THE PLAYGROUND?

Scan for the following playground design features:

	Yes	No
Gates okay for assisted access and assistive devices:		
• Entrance wide enough to pass through with assistant?		
• Opening handle placed within reaching distance?		
Features incorporated to aid spatial orientation, communication and guidance		
Transparency in design enabling easy overview and navigation of the playground		
Easy access to and around all play equipment		
Edges in contrasting textures and colours to aid visually impaired users		
Height of slopes used with consideration for assistive mobility devices, e.g. wheelchairs		
Accessible seating options along paths, seating and table options at the entrance and near play equipment		
Enough space for assistants and wheelchairs to pass each other, on paths and around play equipment		

CAN USERS STAY IN THE PLAYGROUND?

Check for a playground that offers:

	Yes	No
Restrooms and drinking water close by		
Shading		
Accessible seating and table options		
Colour contrasts on surfaces to assist guidance:		
• Contrasting colours on surfaces at play transitions or play-zone changes		
• Contrasting colours on surfaces around moving play equipment, e.g. rotating or swinging equipment		
• Colour schemes with consideration for visual impairments, e.g. colour blind users		
Signage that aids communication		
List of play ideas, how-to-use guides		
Social play areas — things to do together regardless of ability or age		
Solitary play areas, e.g. play panels or individual rotation pieces		
Quiet areas to withdraw to		
Natural elements, e.g. plants with a clear scent, to help wayfinding and orientation		

CAN USERS PLAY IN THE PLAYGROUND?

Check if equipment is designed with:

	Yes	No
Ground-level accessibility and usability		
Play from all sides (360-degree design)		
Transparency and clear design signals		
Spaciousness to support diverse body sizes, abilities and positions		
Multifunctionality: more ways of use, access and egress		
Independent use for all, e.g.:		
• Elevated activities, e.g. raised sandboxes		
• Wheel-on play equipment, e.g. carousels or ramps to relevant elevated play activities		
Variation in play functions:		
• Solitary play		
• Social play in smaller and bigger groups		
Accessible themed play equipment		
Sensory play variation:		
• Tactile		
• Visual		
• Auditive		
• Proprioceptive		
Thrilling play functions, e.g. speed, height		
Users involved in design		

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Read more about Inclusive Play